

Multiple Choice (10 marks)

1. When was the State of Israel established?
 - (a) 1947
 - (b) 1948
 - (c) 1945
 - (d) 1949
2. What is the name of the most famous dharmashastras, which probably dates from around the first century?
 - (a) Laws of Dharma
 - (b) Laws of Karma
 - (c) Laws of Vishnu
 - (d) Laws of Manu
3. Which Hindu festival involves decorating the house with lights, setting off firecrackers and wearing new clothes?
 - (a) Deepavali
 - (b) Holi
 - (c) Diwali
 - (d) Navaratri
4. The theological term homoousios means which of the following?
 - (a) of a similar substance
 - (b) of the same substance
 - (c) of like substance
 - (d) of human substance
5. The first of the Four Noble Truths teaches which of the following cannot be escaped?
 - (a) Pride
 - (b) Hatred
 - (c) Suffering
 - (d) Fate

True / False (10 marks)

Answer True or False

6. True or False: The term matsuri refers to grand festivals celebrated in Japan, often associated with Shinto traditions.
7. True or False: In the Zoroastrian tradition, the term Gathas refers to hymns that express the teachings of the faith.
8. True or False: In Sikhism, liberation is achieved through ascetic renunciation and withdrawal from the world.
9. True or False: Hearing the Guru's Vak in the morning is primarily for communal confession to cleanse the community.
10. True or False: Mani called God the Mother of Light in his religious beliefs.

Long Form Response (20 marks)

Answer each question with a clear and complete explanation.

11. Discuss the concept of yugas in Hindu tradition and analyze the characteristics of the current age, Kali yuga, along with its significance in the broader context of Hindu beliefs.
12. Discuss the significance of the term "vajra" in religious studies, exploring its meanings as both "diamond" and "thunderbolt," and analyze its implications in spiritual contexts.

End of Paper